UID EX 6 – Hotel Booking App

RAD (Rapid Application Development) is a software development methodology that emphasizes quick development and iteration of prototypes over strict planning and long development cycles. It is ideal for projects where requirements evolve through user feedback and where fast delivery is important. This document applies the RAD methodology to design a Hotel Booking Application — LuxeStay — enabling users to search, compare, and book hotel rooms seamlessly from their mobile devices.

Key Characteristics of RAD:

- Focus on prototypes instead of extensive documentation
- User involvement throughout the development process
- Fast development cycles with frequent iterations
- Reusable components to reduce effort
- Best suited for UI/UX-intensive projects like hotel booking, e-commerce, and travel mobile apps

Phase 1: Requirements Planning

This is where the project goals, system requirements, and user needs are identified. Stakeholders, users, and designers collaborate to decide what needs to be built.

1) Identify Key Features

Navigation:

- Login / Sign Up
- Home (Hotels Near You)
- Hotel Room Selection
- Booking Summary
- Guest Details
- Payment
- Booking Confirmation
- Check-Out & Review

User Actions: Browsing Hotels, Searching by Date/City, Selecting Rooms, Checkout, Tracking Booking Status, Confirming Check-Out

2) Create a Requirements Document:

1. Login or Sign Up to access the LuxeStay hotel booking app
2. View list of hotels near the user with star ratings, price per night, and distance
3. Browse available room types under each hotel with amenities, price, and a Select Room button
4. View booking summary with selected hotel, room type, check-in/check-out dates, and total price
5. Enter guest details including full name, email, phone, ID number, and special requests
6. Choose payment method: Credit Card, Net Banking, UPI/Wallet, or Pay at Hotel
7. Track booking confirmation status: Booking Confirmed, Hotel Notified, Pre-Arrival, Check-In, Check-Out
8. Confirm check-out with a guest review, star rating, and final bill summary

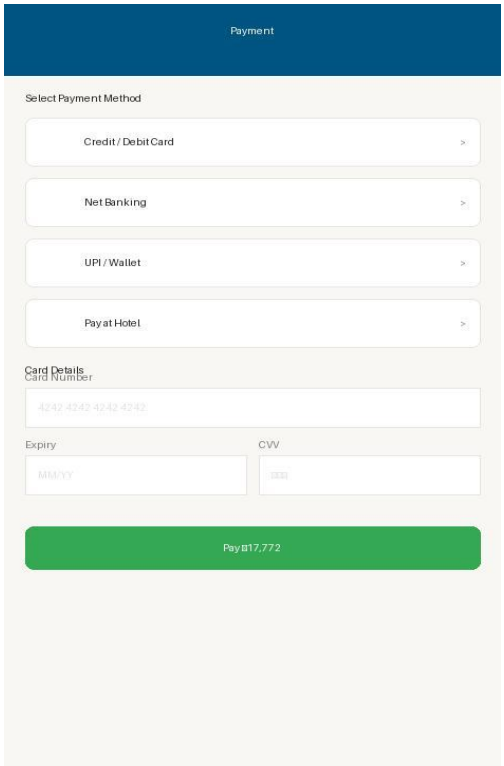
Designers and users collaborate to create wireframes and prototypes. The idea is to show how the application will look and behave before any actual coding starts.

1) Tools Used: Axure RP — Used to design the wireframes and UI prototype.

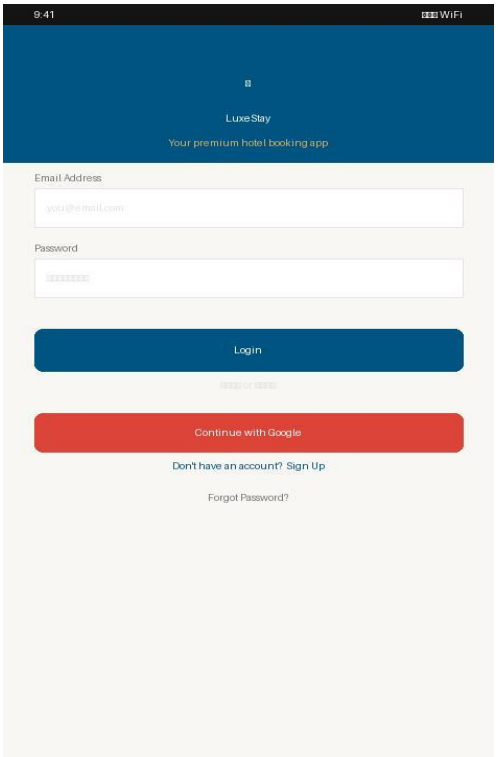
2) Wireframes Designed:

- Login Screen: Email and password fields with Login, Sign Up, and Google login buttons.
- Home Screen: Lists nearby hotels with star ratings, price per night, and distance, plus a search bar and date picker.
- Hotel Detail Screen: Displays hotel amenities, room types with images, prices, and a Select Room button.
- Booking Summary Screen: Displays selected hotel, room, check-in/check-out dates, price breakdown, and Proceed to Guest Details.
- Guest Details Screen: Form for street, city, ZIP, phone, and delivery instructions.
- Payment Screen: Standard, Express, or Scheduled delivery with cost and time.
- Booking Confirmation Screen: Real-time status (Order Placed, Preparing, Out for Delivery, Delivered) and driver info.
- Check-Out & Review Screen: Signature pad, optional photo, and Confirm Delivery button.

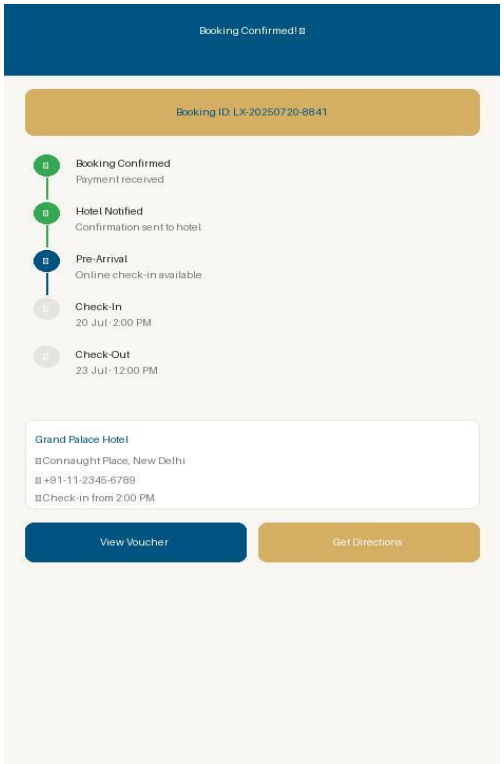
Designed interactions and navigation using Axure's Prototype mode. Reused components like headers/footers using Masters. Annotated elements for clarity (e.g., what a button does, purpose of sections).



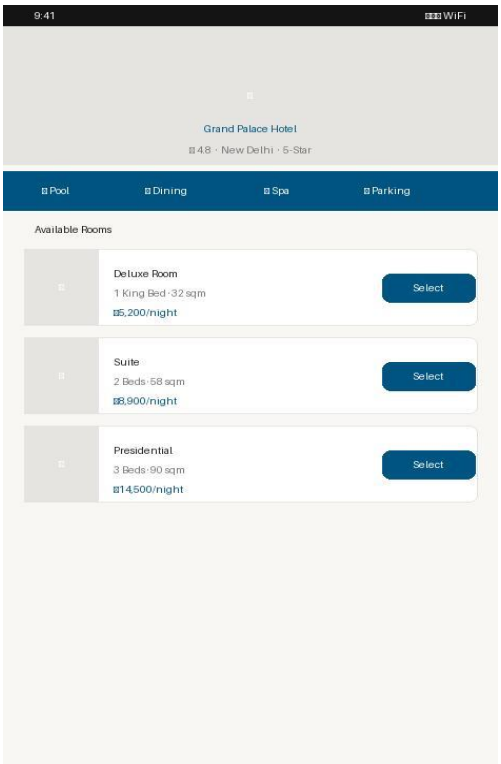
Screen 1: Login Screen



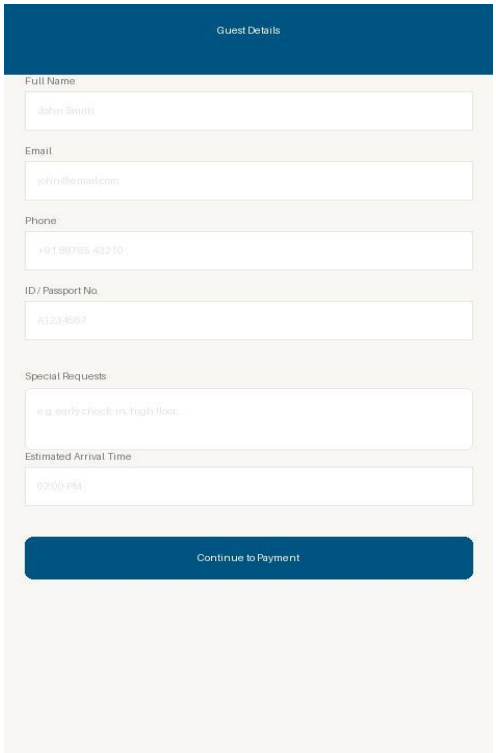
Screen 2: Home – Hotels Near You



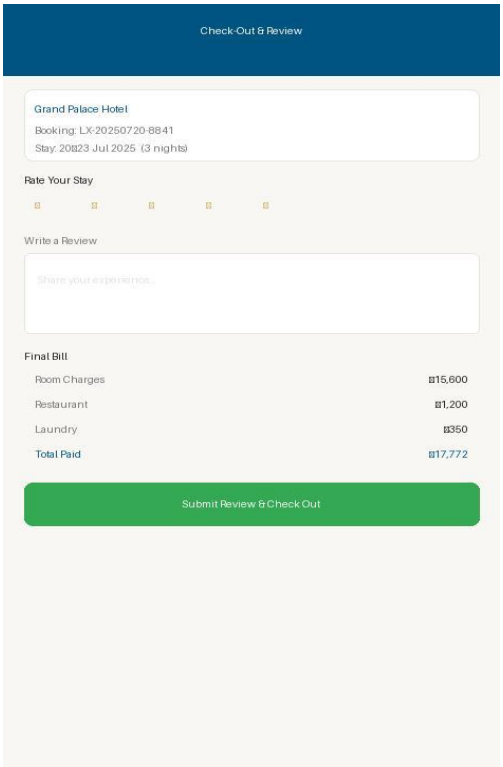
Screen 3: Hotel Detail & Room Selection



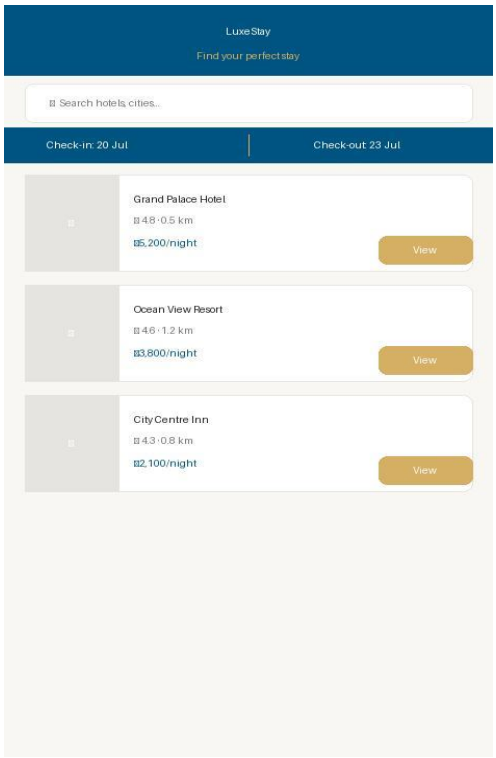
Screen 4: Booking Summary



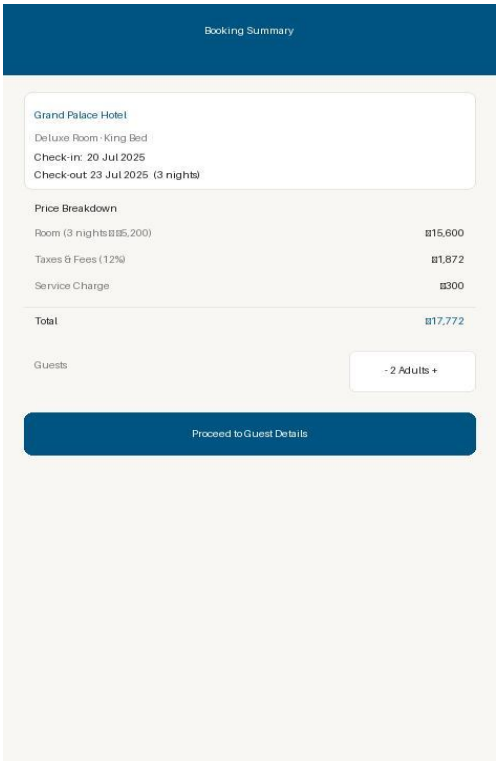
Screen 5: Guest Details



Screen 6: Payment



Screen 7: Booking Confirmation



Screen 8: Check-Out & Review

Phase 3: Construction

This is where the actual development happens, but in RAD, it is tightly coupled with ongoing testing and feedback. The prototype is refined based on user responses.

1) Interactive Prototypes:

- Created using Axure's prototype linking features.
- Functional paths designed:

  o Login → Home (Hotels Near You) → Room Selection → Select Room → Booking Summary → Guest Details → Payment → Booking Confirmation → Check-Out & Review

2) Dynamic Elements:

- Simulated transitions between screens for selecting rooms, entering guest details, and completing payment.
- Screens simulate real-time behavior such as navigating between hotel listings, room selection, and the booking summary.
- Booking confirmation status timeline with step indicators created using dynamic panels.
- Signature pad on Check-Out & Review screen simulates interactive input.

3) Testing and Iteration:

- Prototype previewed using Axure's "Present" / Live Preview mode.
- Collected feedback from stakeholders on hotel search UX, booking flow clarity, and payment screen layout (assumed for documentation).
- Iterated based on visual hierarchy, date picker usability, price display clarity, and overall booking flow suggestions.

Phase 4: Cutover

In this final phase, the system goes live. This includes finalizing the design, training users, and preparing documentation for developers.

1) Finalization and Export:

- Final hotel booking prototype shared through Axure Cloud link, covering all 8 screens from Login to Check-Out & Review.
- Ready for hand-off to the development team.
- Can be exported to HTML/CSS using Axure's built-in publish features.

2) User Training and Support:

- Walkthrough of the prototype for stakeholders or development team.
- Notes/documentation provided for developers to understand the hotel booking functionality, screen transitions, and user flow.
- Easy access to Axure comments for further collaboration and questions.